

S05-03 - Holding the Line

Player text

The skeletons come in a clatter of rust and bone: not clever, but endless, and all of them reaching for the glowing figure at the center. For every one you put down, the ritual's clock ticks a notch closer to done. But they keep clawing up out of the dirt, and the Custodian cannot defend herself. The line is yours to hold.

Public objective

Defeat the rusted dead and keep the Custodian safe.

GM goal

Run the rusted-sword skeleton wave as clear protection pressure and countdown progress.

GM notes

- Skeletons are pressure and countdown fuel, not a slog. Keep them moving toward the Custodian.

GM script

Say: "They are not strong. They are persistent, and they want her, not you. Stand in the way. Every one you drop moves the countdown down by one."

State controls

- ward_stability Ward Stability select fragile stable
- ritual_prep Ritual Prep select unready ready
- keystone_understanding Keystone Understanding select surface deep
- ritual_countdown Ritual Countdown number 10 8
- ritual_outcome Ritual Outcome select unresolved clean costly pyrrhic
- protected_whom Protected Whom select unresolved custodian party hush shared
- custodian_fate Custodian Fate select unresolved well drained dying
- strixwolf_disposition Strixwolf Disposition select unresolved calm hostile killed
- strixwolf_outcome Strixwolf Outcome select unresolved calmed helped avoided attacked killed
- strixwolf_trust Strixwolf Trust number 3
- strixwolf_blood_debt Strixwolf Blood Debt checkbox
- bramble_outcome Bramble Outcome select unresolved killed captured spared negotiated escaped let_cargo
- bramble_truth_learned Bramble Truth Learned checkbox
- package_status Package Status select held lost
- hush_trust Hush Trust select low neutral high
- custodian_route Custodian Route select unknown safe dangerous
- ward_awareness Ward Awareness select none seed aware

- festival_boon Festival Boon select none charm favor market_find goodwill
- custodian_trust Custodian Trust select low neutral high
- hush_clues Hush Clues select none custodian_route ward_seed corporate_seam farm_seed
market_rumor multiple

Export Stamp

Build 2026-06-23T21:40:58 | Content hash e0430f0b06f3a9d3 | Source hash
dac3370046ed077140fab2d6